

CAREER IDENTITY STATEMENT

**"I make cloud security
understandable for the people who
have to actually implement it, not
just the people who design it."**

A month-by-month build plan for the identity, certifications, projects, and public work behind a real move into cloud security, starting from zero and becoming visible as a practitioner within a year.

Who I'm becoming this year

BY JULY 2027, I AM

A cloud security practitioner with real, demonstrable technical skill: certified, hands-on, and known for a small but real body of public work. Someone early in the field can trust and learn from, because I document the climb honestly instead of performing expertise I haven't earned yet. Not a beginner anymore, but not pretending to be a ten-year veteran either. Credible, visible, and building toward a role or income stream inside cloud security.

Core Expertise

Cloud security fundamentals: identity and access management, misconfiguration detection, and secure-by-default cloud architecture.

Unique Angle

The ability to translate technical security concepts into something a non-security person can actually act on, instead of jargon that gets ignored.

Audience

Other early-career people trying to break into cloud security, and technical audiences who follow the build-in-public journey.

Proof

Certifications earned, projects shipped, open source contributions merged, and a public record of talks, articles, and videos across the year.

Why this identity

Most people enter cloud security by chasing certifications alone, which puts them in direct competition with everyone else doing the same thing. This identity is built on a real gap instead: technical depth without the ability to explain it produces security nobody follows. The goal this year is to build the technical depth for real, and let the ability to explain things clearly be the differentiator once the skill is genuinely there.

Monthly progress: Aug 2026 – Jan 2027

Month 1

Aug 2026

Start from zero, on purpose

- Begin AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner study
 - Set up a private learning log to capture concepts in my own words
 - Follow 10 to 15 cloud security practitioners to learn how the field talks about problems
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Month 2

Sep 2026

First hands-on environment

- Build first home-lab project: a small AWS environment I intentionally misconfigure and then secure
 - Continue certification study
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Month 3

Oct 2026

First certification, first article

- Sit the AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner exam
 - Publish first article: what I learned securing my home-lab environment
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Month 4

Nov 2026

Go public

- Publish first short video explaining one cloud security concept simply
 - Begin CompTIA Security+ study
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Month 5

Dec 2026

First open source contribution

- Make first contribution to a security-related open source project (docs, small fix, or config)
 - Start building Project 1: a cloud security checklist tool
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Month 6

Jan 2027

Midpoint check

- Sit the CompTIA Security+ exam
- Ship Project 1 publicly
- Publish second article and second video

Monthly progress: Feb 2027 – Jul 2027

Month 7

Feb 2027

Go deeper

- Begin AWS Certified Security – Specialty study
- Start Project 2: a documented incident response playbook for a cloud breach scenario

Month 8

Mar 2027

First talk

- Speak at a local or virtual meetup for the first time, beginner-friendly topic
- Publish third article

Month 9

Apr 2027

Second open source contribution

- Make second, more substantial open source contribution (a script or small tool)
- Ship Project 2 publicly

Month 10

May 2027

Flagship resource

- Sit the AWS Certified Security – Specialty exam
- Ship a signature resource: a beginner's guide to cloud security, built from the year's learning

Month 11

Jun 2027

Third contribution, more visibility

- Make third open source contribution
- Publish fourth and fifth articles, fourth video

Month 12

Jul 2027

Review and reposition

- Pitch to speak at a larger conference or CFP
- Review the year: which certifications, projects, and public work actually built the identity, and plan year two

3

CERTIFICATIONS

3

PROJECTS SHIPPED

3

OPEN SOURCE PRS

2

TALKS GIVEN

Full breakdown of certifications and targets on the following pages.

Certifications to earn

1

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

The foundational entry point: cloud concepts, security basics, and how AWS is structured.

Month 3

2

CompTIA Security+

Vendor-neutral security fundamentals that apply across any cloud platform, not just AWS.

Month 6

3

AWS Certified Security – Specialty

The credential that signals real cloud security depth, not just general cloud knowledge.

Month 10

Why this order

Cloud Practitioner builds the vocabulary. Security+ builds the security fundamentals that transfer across any cloud provider. Security Specialty is the one that actually signals depth, and it only makes sense to attempt once the first two are solid. Three certifications in a year is enough. More than that risks becoming credential collection instead of real skill.

Study cadence: roughly 5 to 7 hours a week outside of current work and product launches, adjusted as needed month to month.

Content pillars for the year

1 Learning in public

Concepts explained the way I wish someone had explained them to me. Honest about the climb, not a highlight reel of expertise I haven't earned yet.

2 Technical translation

Taking a cloud security concept and explaining it clearly for someone without a security background, so it's actually usable.

3 Building in public

Documenting the home-lab projects, the checklist tool, and the playbook as they're built, not just the finished result.

4 Open source journey

What it's like contributing to open source for the first time as a beginner: the fear, the first merged PR, what I'd do differently.

Guardrails

- Say "learning" until something is shipped, then let the work speak for itself
- Don't chase every certification available; three well-chosen ones say more than five scattered ones
- Keep this as a background build for the first few months so it doesn't compete with current product launches
- Revisit the identity statement each quarter and sharpen it as the work clarifies what's actually true

Projects, open source, and visibility

Projects to Build

3

BY MONTH 10

Home-lab secure environment, cloud security checklist tool, and an incident response playbook.

Open Source Contributions

3

BY MONTH 11

Starting small with docs or config fixes, moving toward a real script or tool contribution.

Articles Written

5

BY MONTH 11

One published roughly every two months, each tied to something actually learned or built.

Videos Made

4

BY MONTH 11

Short, simple explainers of one concept at a time, starting as soon as Month 4.

Talks or Events

2

BY MONTH 12

One local or virtual meetup talk as a beginner speaker, then one pitch to a larger conference.

Certifications Earned

3

BY MONTH 10

Cloud Practitioner, Security+, and AWS Security Specialty, in that sequence.

These are beginner-level targets, deliberately modest. The goal in year one is a real, honest body of work, not volume. Year two can raise the numbers once the identity has proof behind it.